

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Ms Sakina Schwarz

Address: 8 Foxley Court Christchurch Park Sutton SM2 5UE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am a local resident in the SM2 area, and I support this application.

I do not have family nearby, so having a sense of community is very important to me. Through BASMA, I was able to find connection and support locally, which has made a real difference to both my wellbeing and my child's. As a mature mother raising one child on my own, access to a supportive, culturally aware environment for women and families matters greatly, and this should be available when needed, not only once a week. Due to health complications, I am unable to travel further and increasingly rely on support from this local community, which is currently limited to a very short experience once a week.

Most attendees are local residents, and the proposed site is better suited than the current temporary arrangement. There will not be a sudden increase in new people attending the facility. Currently, the main weekly gathering is Friday prayer, which is short and predictable. People attend in an orderly way, stay briefly and leave calmly, and this has not caused noise or disturbance in the area. There are no prayers during the busy school morning period, so this does not, and will not affect peak morning traffic. I can only envision that this location will make traffic and noise better by reducing congestion in the busy streets around the Church.

BASMA is a known and established part of the local community and has consistently managed activities responsibly over several years. For residents like me, especially women and single parents, this centre would provide important local support, connection and stability.

I hope the Council will approve this proposal as it provides a much-needed community space for

Sutton residents who rely on local services as their closest place of worship and community support.